

Cases of Noun

There are three types of cases of noun, which are as follow

1. Nominative Case

A noun or pronoun is in the nominative case if it is used as the subject of a verb.

e.g. – Sachin Tendulkar scored a century.

Clue Put *Who* in active sentence and *What* in passive sentence before the verb to get nominative case.

2. Objective Case

A noun or pronoun is in the objective case if it is used as the object of a verb.

e.g. – Sachin Tendulkar scored *a century* (Active).
– A century was scored by Sachin Tendulkar (Passive).

Clue Put *What* in active sentence and *Whom* in the passive sentence after the subject and the verb to get the objective case.

3. Possessive Case

A noun is said to be in the possessive case if it denotes possession, authorship, origin, kind, etc.

e.g. – Amit's house is at the back-side.

How is Possessive Case Formed

- By adding's to a singular noun.
e.g. – Amit's, Donald's.
- By adding's to plural nouns not ending in s.
e.g. – Children's school, Men's club.
- By adding only an apostrophe to a plural noun ending in s.
e.g. – Boys', victims', pilgrims'.
- By adding only an apostrophe to a singular noun when there are hissing sounds.
e.g. – Jesus' blessings, for peace' sake, for conscience' sake.

Rules of Possessive Case

- In case of a compound noun, the possessive sign is attached only to the last word.
e.g. – My brother-in-law's marriage.
– The Queen-of-England's residence.
- When two or more nouns show joint possession, the apostrophe sign is put with the latter only.
e.g. – Dharmendra is Sunny and Bobby's father.
- The words his, hers, its, theirs, yours, ours are possessive and they are not written with the possessive sign.
e.g. – Neither did his efforts succeed nor ~~your's~~ / yours.
- The adverb 'else' combined with indefinite pronouns (somebody, anybody, etc) is expressed in possessive case as 'somebody else's' in place of 'somebody's else'.
e.g. – Is it your house? I thought it is ~~somebody's~~ else-/somebody else's?

- The words church, house, school, shop are often omitted after a possessive case.

e.g. – Yesterday I met my friend at St John's.

- The possessive case is chiefly used with the names of living things.

- The possessive case is also used with nouns denoting time, space or weight.

e.g. – Stone's throw away distance

– A minute's time

– A day's journey

Confusing Words

Word	Meaning	Example
Advice	Singular means an opinion or suggestion.	The teacher gave many pieces of advice to the students before the exam.
Advices	Plural (Advices) means information.	The invigilator gave advices to the students before the exam.
Cloth	Singular means unfinished product.	We give cloth to a tailor to get the clothes stitched.
Clothes	Plural means garments.	
Colour	Singular and plural means red, green, etc.	Yellow is my favourite colour.
Colours	(Plural only) implies 'true personality of someone'.	A realist sees true colours of people.
Force	Singular means strength.	Apply force to open the lid.
Forces	Plural means the military organisations for air, land and sea.	Forces landed at the disputed spot on time.
Content	Singular means satisfaction.	I am content with the contents of this book.
Contents	Plural means parts.	
Light	Singular means radiance.	There was a light on the ascetic's face.
Lights	Singular and plural means lamps.	Diwali is a festival of lights.
People	Singular is used when we are talking about masses.	
Peoples	Plural means people belonging to different cultures and ethnicities.	People of India, Peoples of Europe.
Practice	Singular means exercise of a profession.	It is compulsory for new doctors to practice in villages for 2 years in the beginning of their career.
Practices	(Both singular and plural) means habit.	
Custom	Singular means tradition.	One should respect one's custom and traditions.
Customs	Plural means a department.	The customs department seized illegal goods at the airport.

Words Denoting Groups

1. An *army* of soldiers.
2. An *alliance* of states, powers, etc.
3. An *assembly* of representatives.
4. An *attendance* of servants, persons.
5. An *audience* of listeners.
6. A *band* of musicians, followers.
7. A *batch* of pupils, candidates.
8. A *battery* of guns.
9. A *bench* of judges or magistrates.
10. A *block* of houses, buildings.
11. A *body* of men, soldiers, police, laws, etc.
12. A *brigade* of cavalry, infantry or artillery.
13. A *bundle* of hay.
14. A *bouquet* of flowers.
15. A *board* of trustees or directors.
16. A *caravan* of merchants.
17. A *code* of laws.
18. A *congress* of representatives.
19. A *century* of runs.
20. A *cloud* of locusts.
21. A *cluster* of islands.
22. A *constellation* of stars.
23. A *course* of lectures.
24. A *consignment* of goods.
25. A *catalogue* of books.
26. A *circle* of friends, acquaintances.
27. A *clan* of people.
28. A *clique* of persons (belonging to a body).
29. A *commonwealth* of bees.
30. A *concourse* of people.
31. A *confederacy* of persons, nations, states.
32. A *confederation* of persons, powers, states.
33. A *conference* of preachers, delegates.
34. A *congregation* of worshippers.
35. A *convoy* of ships.
36. A *corporation* of people.
37. A *corps* of soldiers, volunteers, police.
38. A *curriculum* of studies.
39. A *crew* of sailors.
40. A *herd* of cattle.
41. An *escort* of soldiers.
42. A *fraction* of people (engaged in politics).
43. A *family* of plants, languages.
44. A *federation* of states.

SPOTTING THE ERRORS SET 1

✓ ERRORS OF NOUN

Directions (Q.Nos. 1-30) Which part of the given sentences has an error? In case, there is no error, choose option (d).

1. Order has been issued (a)/ for his transfer to another district (b)/ but he has not received them so far. (c)/ No error (d)
2. Although she has studied (a)/ English for almost a year (b)/ she is yet to learn the alphabets. (c)/ No error (d)
3. There are two scores of books (a)/ which are lying (b)/ unused in the library. (c)/ No error (d)
4. Children are prone (a)/ to making mischiefs (b)/ if they have nothing to do. (c)/ No error (d)
5. Sheeps are economically useful (a)/ and so they are reared (b)/ in the hills. (c)/ No error (d)
6. I have not gone through (a)/ the letter and so I am not aware (b)/ of its content. (c)/ No error (d)
7. I shall not attend the meeting (a)/ since I have many works to complete (b)/ within allotted time. (c)/ No error (d)
8. You should always be (a)/ true to your words (b)/ if you are to succeed in life. (c)/ No error (d)
9. It is a pity (a)/ that even five years old boys (b)/ are engaged in hazardous factories. (c)/ No error (d)
10. I gave him (a)/ two hundred rupees notes (b)/ for depositing. (c)/ No error (d)
11. It is not my business (a)/ to give an advice to those (b)/ who are not sensible enough to deal with their own problems. (c)/ No error (d)
12. I don't think (a)/ it is your house (b)/ It is somebody's else. (c)/ No error (d)
13. She misplaced her spectacle (a)/ and is now feeling (b)/ great difficulty in studying. (c)/ No error (d)
14. Arabian Nights are (a)/ a collection of (b)/ very interesting episodes of adventure. (c)/ No error (d)
15. I hope to visit (a)/ my uncle only next year (b)/ during summer vacations. (c)/ No error (d)
16. Ration has run out (a)/ and the District Magistrate (b)/ has been informed. (c)/ No error (d)

17. The table's wood (a)/ is infested with mite (b)/ and I am likely to dispose it off. (c)/ No error (d)
18. I can't come to you now (a)/ because a lot of works (b)/ remains to be done. (c)/ No error (d)
19. A farmer was leading oxes (a)/ to his field for ploughing (b)/ early in the morning. (c)/ No error (d)
20. My sister-in-laws (a)/who live in Mumbai (b)/ have come to stay with us. (c)/ No error (d)
21. This article (a)/ is not available (b)/ in any of the shop in the market. (c)/No error (d)
22. The morale of the army (a)/ was high because the news (b)/ coming from the front are very encouraging. (c)/ No error (d)
23. A flock of lions (a)/ roamed about (b)/ fearlessly in the jungle. (c)/ No error (d)
24. I have done my best; (a)/ the whole thing is now (b)/ in the laps of God. (c)/ No error (d)
25. A trained gang of sailors (a)/ was employed (b)/ on the ship. (c)/ No error (d)
26. Interviews for (a)/ the posts of lecturers (b)/ will begin from Monday. (c)/ No error (d)
27. What (a)/ is the criteria (b)/ of selection in the examination? (c)/ No error (d)
28. Satyajit Ray, who conceived, co-authored (a)/ and directed a number of good films, was (b)/ one of India's most talented film-maker. (c)/ No error (d)
29. One of the most (a)/ widespread bad habit (b)/ is the use of tobacco. (c)/ No error (d)
30. The books (a)/ that you need (b)/ are kept on the table. (c)/ No error (d)

► EXPLANATIONS

- (a) When a person is assigned to a new station, he receives his 'orders'. This is a set of instructions, including where to be, when to be there etc. So, the correct sentence would be 'Orders have been issued
- (c) 'Alphabet' is the set of letters in a language. English alphabet has 26 letters from A-Z. In the given sentence, we will use 'alphabet' instead of 'alphabets'.
- (a) When a quantity is given before 'score' like '2' or '5' etc, 'score' is not used in the plural form. Hence, we would use 'score' in place of 'scores' in the given sentence.
- (b) The word 'mischief' does not have a plural form. Hence, 'mischief' would be used.
- (a) The plural of 'sheep' is 'sheep'. In the given sentence, the word 'Sheeps' would be replaced by 'Sheep'.
- (c) The word 'content' is used in its plural form 'contents' when it is used to mean 'something contained'. So, the given sentence will have 'contents' instead of 'content'.
- (b) As 'work' is an uncountable noun we need to use 'much work' instead of 'many works'.
- (b) 'True to your word' means 'promise'. In the given sentence, we would replace 'true to your words' by 'true to your word'.
- (b) As we know that in a compound noun, a compound word is not used in plural if a noun does the work of an adjective.
In the given sentence, 'five years old' is an adjective of noun 'boys'. So, 'five year old' would be used instead of 'five years old'.
- (b) In the given sentence, 'two hundred rupees' is used as an adjective of the noun 'notes'. So, it should be 'two hundred rupee'. (For explanation refer to Ans. 9).
- (b) As 'advice' is an uncountable noun, the article 'an' would not be used before it.
- (c) The possessive pronoun in the given sentence 'somebody's else' is incorrectly used. Its correct usage will be 'somebody else's'.
- (a) The correct usage of 'spectacle' is 'spectacles'.
- (a) The book 'Arabian Nights' is a singular noun. So, 'are' would be replaced by 'is'.
- (c) The correct use of 'vacations' is 'vacation'.
- (a) 'Rations have run out' should be used.
- (a) 'The table's wood' does not seem appropriate. It should be replaced by 'The wood of the table' which makes sense.
- (b) As 'work' is an uncountable noun, 'because a lot of work' would be used.
- (a) The plural of 'ox' is 'oxen'. In the sentence, 'oxes' is used instead of 'oxen' which is incorrect.
- (a) The plural of sister-in-law would be sisters-in-law. So, we would replace 'sister-in-laws' by 'sisters-in-law'.
- (c) 'Any' refers to a number of things (here shops). So, we would replace 'shop' by 'shops'.
- (c) 'News' is used as a singular noun. So, 'coming from the front is very encouraging' would be used.
- (a) 'Pride' is the right word to refer to a group of lions. So, we would replace 'flock' by 'pride'.
- (c) 'Laps' is incorrect. It should be changed to 'lap'.
- (a) A group of sailors is called a crew. So, we would replace 'gang' by 'crew'.
- (b) 'Posts' should be replaced by 'post' to make the sentence correct.
- (b) 'Criteria' should be replaced by 'criterion' to make the sentence correct.
- (c) 'Film-maker' should be changed to 'film-makers'.
- (b) 'One of' takes a plural noun. So, we would change 'habit' to 'habits'.
- (d) No error.

PRONOUN

Words used in place of nouns are called pronouns. They are used to avoid the repetition of nouns in a sentence. e.g. I saw a boy on the roof. He seemed to recognise me.

In this example, the pronoun 'he' is used instead of repeating the noun 'boy' which is underlined.

Kinds of Pronoun

Personal Pronouns

This pronoun refers to or is related to the words which are used in place of nouns referring to person.

Personal pronouns have the following characteristics

1st Person : The one(s) speaking (I, me, my, mine, we, us, our, ours).

2nd Person : The one(s) spoken to (you, your, yours).

3rd Person : The one(s) spoken about (he, him, his, she, her, hers, it, its, they, their, theirs).

Persons	Nominative Case		Objective Case		Possessive Case	
	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
I Person	I	We	Me	Us	My/Mine	Our/Ours
II Person	You	You	You	You	Your/Yours	Your/Yours
III Person						
Male	He	} They	Him	} Them	His	} Their/Theirs
Female	She		Her		Her/Hers	
Neuter	It		It		Its	

Rules of Personal Pronouns

1. A personal pronoun must be of the same number, gender and person as the noun for which it stands, i.e. antecedent should agree with the noun.

e.g. - I am not one of those who believe everything ~~I~~ / they see.
 - Every man must love his / ~~her~~ / ~~their~~ country.
 - He is one of the best boys that have played here.

2. The component of the verb *to be* (*is, am, are, was, were, will, shall*), when it is expressed by a pronoun, should be in the nominative case.

To be means

<i>Is</i>	:	He, She, It
<i>Am</i>	:	I
<i>Are</i>	:	We, You, They
<i>Was</i>	:	I, He, She, It
<i>Were</i>	:	We, You, They
<i>Will</i>	:	You, He, She, It, They
<i>Shall</i>	:	I, We

e.g. - It is ~~me~~ / I.

- It will be he / ~~him~~ who is going to win.

- Was it ~~her~~ / she who did it for you?

3. If a pronoun is used as the object of the verb or of a preposition, it should be in the objective case.

e.g. - He was shouting at ~~I~~ / me.

- He was teaching ~~he~~ / him.

- The sweets are to be distributed among you, him and me.

4. Objective case is used after the following words *let, like, but*, etc.

e.g. - It is no one else but ~~he~~ / him who has done the crime.

- He likes me.

- Let him come inside.

5. Words such as *as good as, as well as, as soon as, as beautiful as, as intelligent as, etc* are followed by nominative case.

e.g. - When it comes to providing news, no one is as good as he.

- In studies he is as good as he.

6. **2, 3, 1 Rule** The second person should come before the third and the third person before the first. This case applies to singular pronouns only.

e.g. - I, You and He are good friends. (X)

- You, He and I are good friends. (✓)

7. **1, 2, 3 Rule** 2, 3, 1 becomes 1, 2, 3 when we are talking about plural pronouns.

e.g. - We, You and They will go to the party.

- We, You and They will take dinner at our/ their / your house.

Exception When it comes to confessing something or committing a crime, 2, 3, 1 gets changed to 1, 2, 3 for all types of pronouns.

e.g. - I, you and he will be punished for the crime.

8. When a pronoun stands for a collective noun, it must be in the neuter gender. But if the collective noun denotes separation or division, the pronoun used is plural.

e.g. - The jury gave its decision unanimously.

- The jury were divided in their opinion.

9. When two or more nouns are joined by 'and', the pronoun used would be plural.

e.g. - Ram and Mohan went to their school.

- Suresh and his family members have completed their work.

Case I *Separate persons, the pronoun used for them must be plural.*

Case II *Same person, the pronoun used for them must be singular.*

[**Hint** If a single Article is used before the nouns, the verb and the pronoun are both singular, because the reference is to a singular person only].

- e.g. - The Comptroller and Auditor General
 has / ~~have~~ submitted *his* / ~~their~~ report.
 - The Chairman and the Managing Director
 ~~has~~ / *have* submitted ~~his~~ / *their* report.

10. When two or more singular nouns are joined by or, either-or or neither-nor, the pronoun and the verb should be singular.
 e.g. - Either Raj or Amar *is* doing *his* duty.
11. Whenever one singular and one plural noun are used with either-or or neither-nor, the plural noun always comes second. In this case, the verb and the pronoun both become plural.
 e.g. - Neither Amit nor his friends ~~was~~ / *were* present in *their* house.
12. While writing question tag, the subject and verb must be according to the main sentence.
 e.g. - Our minister is intelligent, *isn't he*?
 - The boys are not enjoying themselves, *are they*?
 - They went to Delhi yesterday, *didn't they*?

Reflexive Pronouns

Reflexive pronouns are pronouns that refer back to the subject of the sentence. They end in-'self', as in singular form, or-'selves' in plural form.

- e.g. - Myself, themselves, yourself, ourselves etc.

Rules of Reflexive Pronouns

- The reflexive pronoun is used with the following words absent, avail, apply, enjoy, pride, resign, acquit, revenge, exert, adapt, adjust, etc.
 e.g. - He absented *himself* from the class.
 - He acquitted *himself* admirably in the meeting.
- With the following words, reflexive pronouns are not used: bathe, break, feed, hide, turn, move, rest, qualify, stop, etc.
 e.g. - We *bathed* in the river.
 - We *fed* at the motel.
- A reflexive pronoun cannot be used as a substitute for the subject.
 e.g. - Amit and I / ~~myself~~ were present on the site.
 - I / *Myself* will see to it that you do not get the job.

Demonstrative Pronouns

The pronouns that are used to point out the objects to which they refer are called demonstrative pronouns like these, that, those, such, it, this, etc.

- e.g. - *That* is the book I was looking for.

Rules of Demonstrative Pronouns

- Do not commit the error of omission by forgetting to use 'that' (for plural use 'those').
 e.g. - The Mumbai Film Studio is *bigger than* (X)
 Noida.
 - The Mumbai Film Studio is *bigger than* (✓)
 that of Noida.
- Pronoun 'it' comes before the phrase or clause to which it refers, whereas 'this' follows the phrase or clause it refers to.
 e.g. - *This* is true that India has won the match. (X)
 - *It* is true that India has won the match. (✓)

Indefinite Pronouns

When a pronoun refers to a person or a thing in a general way, but not to any person or thing in particular, it is called indefinite pronoun like any, anyone, none, someone, everyone, everybody, one, etc.

Rules of Indefinite Pronouns

- One, if used in a sentence, always repeats itself.
 e.g. - *One* must respect ~~his~~ / *one's* country for ~~his~~ / *one's* sake.
 - *One* must obey ~~their~~ / *one's* elders.
- When we are not talking specifically about females, only masculine gender is used.
 e.g. - Everyone was getting ready for *his* / ~~her~~ *show*.
 - Everyone of the Miss India contestants was getting ready for *her* show.
- 'Either' is replaced by 'anyone' when we are talking about more than two persons or things. Same is the case with 'none' or 'neither'.
 e.g. - I couldn't contact ~~either~~ / *anyone* of the three.
 - *Anyone* of the three can come in.
 - None / ~~Neither~~ of his body parts is defective.
- 'Each other' should be used in speaking of two persons or things, 'one another' in speaking of more than two persons or things.
 e.g. - We should love *one another*.

Relative Pronouns

This pronoun refers or relates to some noun which comes after this pronoun. Besides, it acts as a conjunction also because it connects two sentences.

- e.g. - Who, whom, which, where, etc.
 - He is the boy *who* has topped the class.

Rules of Relative Pronouns

- 'Who' is used for subject and 'Whom' for object.
 e.g. - *Who* are you?
 - *Whom* were you talking to?
 - She is the girl ~~who~~ / *whom* I met in the train.